



Key to good health

- Using your phone while driving is a punishable offence. Let the caller know that you are driving, and suspend the conversation.
- You can use a hands-free accessory available, but making use of this while driving is also an offence under the law.
- Even while walking, ensure you stand on the side of the pavement while talking over a mobile phone. Avoid using it while crossing roads as your attention is always diverted during a conversation.
- Always buy cell phones, that are SAR (Specific Absorption Rate) approved—it is a measure of the rate of absorption of RF energy in the body—this ensures that the radiations emitted by them are in the minimal range.
- Keep the phone away from electronic devices as this causes EMI (electro-magnetic interference). While travelling in an aeroplane always switch off the mobile to prevent any sort of interference with the navigation systems of the airplane. Similar care must be taken when in hospitals and petrol pumps.

Nokia 8910 Natural

Price: Rs 35,499 C+

The 8910 comes in a titanium shell that aims to offer maximum protection. The sliding mechanism is great to use, and is of a good build-quality. The keys are well laid out, but a bit cumbersome due to the small size—the last row is particularly more difficult to get at as the rim of the shell interferes with the accessibility. This was one of the few phones that carried an exhaustive accessory package with it—an extra battery pack, a desktop charger, a leather pouch and a headset.



The user may be dissatisfied on the software front, as it neither supports MMS nor has the facility of concatenated messages—you only get the old-fashioned four line display. The phone supports connectivity through Bluetooth, as well as Infrared. Phones with Bluetooth allow exchange of contacts using this medium—however the 8910 only allows an infrared or SMS transfer. This phone has a faster processor than its predecessor, the 8855 and you can instantly feel the difference when it opens your filled inbox. It allows you to store around 500 contacts and 150 messages.

On the performance front, this phone provided astounding voice clarity even when the signal was at the weakest. All this makes it a pretty neat phone to flaunt, if you can afford the price.

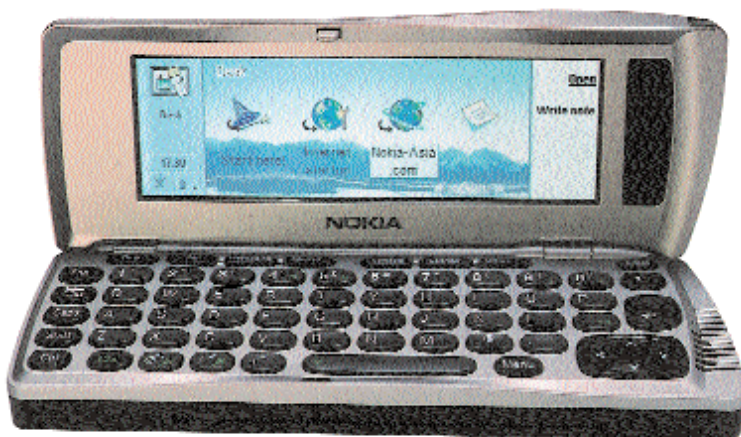
- + Titanium shell for protection, range of accessories bundled, fast processor, GPRS, voice clarity
- Small screen, difficulty in using the keys, no concatenated messages, no real-time e-mail

Nokia 9210i Communicator

Price: Rs 37,599 C

This mobile phone is targeted at corporate users and professionals who would like to have the functionality of office applications in a phone. The 9210i is quite big in size when compared to other phones with similar functionality, the grip however, is very firm. There are two display screens—the one on the outer surface is monochromatic and offers a glimpse at the basic functions of the phone, the other is a 4,096 colour screen on the inside that shows you the various PDA functions. The flip is that none of the screens are touch-sensitive. The resulting juggling with buttons takes time. The buttons are well placed and the white backlight does not hinder readability.

The Nokia 9210i offers a QWERTY keyboard on the inside panel, which allows you to type your text and insert characters. It has a Symbian operating system and a whopping 40 MB of memory, out of which 16 MB is allocated for applications. Out of this 16 MB, 6 MB of applications are preinstalled, thus only 10 MB of memory remains for personal use. If you want additional memory, you can add a 64 MB MultiMedia Card (MMC).



The phone comes with a word processor, a presentation viewer, and a spreadsheet program. It has an exhaustive calendar, an updated browser with support for Java script, Cascading Style Sheet offers a better Web experience.

A voice recorder allows you to record more than 10 minutes of voice (depending upon the memory occupied) and a note application lets you to make some quick notes.

It's surprising to see that the Communicator lacks GPRS and MMS, which most of the newer set of phones possess.

This phone has good voice clarity—one thing that we did find amiss was its inability to catch a signal in sensitive areas, where other models from Nokia performed admirably. Overall, this is a phone that provides some excellent functionality but seriously requires the manufacturer to upgrade the software to compete with the upcoming models.

- + Sturdy display screen, office viewer, browser supporting Java and CSS, capability of adding external memory
- No support for Bluetooth, GPRS, MMS

